



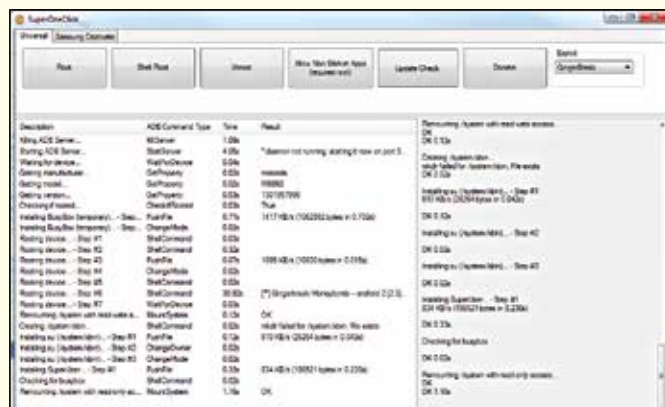
included with Google's Android SDK. The problem with the first tool is that your phone needs to be rooted to use Titanium Backup as it requires root permissions, and brings into existence the classic chicken and egg problem. Titanium Backup is useful on rooted phones that you plan on installing a custom ROM on. You'd want to make sure that all your installed applications, settings and the original firmware are available to you in case you run into any problems. Another advice here is to go for a Nandroid backup provided by the Clockwork Recovery Mod or your own custom ROM which saves an entire image of the device to the disk for future use.

For Android 4.0 and later, you can use the ADB backup. Just download Holo Backup, a GUI wrapper for conducting the backup, from its homepage at <http://goo.gl/Ya4sL>. Once you get the app running, hit "Backup all without system apps" and you're set. Since this functionality doesn't exist for Android 2.3 or lower, your best bet is to use an application like MyBackup Pro to back up your other data to the SD card or online and ASTRO File Manager to copy your application APKs to a safe location.



Root your phone

The complication for Android is that there are a large variety of phones available in the market today. Now, while some methods do work for a very large cross-section of



SuperOneClick in action

handsets, there's no universal one-size-fits-all rooting solution for every phone out there. We'll start with the one tool that's able to root a lot of models, especially the older ones – it's called SuperOneClick. The catch is that it may or may not work for your phone, so you'll have to dig a little deeper for another tool, especially for older phones as they have their own little quirks.

Download SuperOneClick from <http://goo.gl/QMOIZ> and extract the downloaded zip file. On your phone make sure that USB Debugging is enabled under settings and then connect the phone to your PC. The next step is very important: make sure your SD card is not mounted before proceeding. Once your phone is detected by SuperOneClick, click on "Root" to begin the rooting process and wait for it to complete. That's it! Once the process completes, your phone will be rooted and you can then proceed to the post-rooting section of this guide.

In case you face any problem, search the SuperOneClick support thread on XDA Developers at <http://goo.gl/tzReR> for others with the same problems as you.

This app is known not to work with the following phones. You can use unrevoked.com instead to circumvent the NAND lock used by these phone.

- Sprint HTC EVO 4G (Super-sonic)
- HTC Droid Incredible
- HTC Desire GSM
- HTC Desire CDMA (BravoC)
- HTC Aria
- Droid Eris (HTC DesireC)
- HTC Wildfire (HTC Buzz)

One thing to note here is that there may be other methods as well by which you can root your phone. You'll have to find the one that suits you the best. For example, all phones from HTC released in and after 2011 are allowed by HTC itself to unlock their bootloader (<http://goo.gl/YyWiu>).

The only step you need to perform after this is flashing a custom ROM to your device to get the root access. Now other methods may exist which may do this for your phone in one click, it's entirely up to your discretion to select the method that you're comfortable with.

Some of the latest phones have different exploits and one-click root tools specifically made for them. They're listed in the table below along with links for the respective phone's guide.

You'll find that nearly all links point to XDA Forums. It is infact the mecca of smartphone hacking, rooting and development. Nearly all the developers congregate and collaborate here, making rooting toolkits and apps possible. Whenever in doubt just head over to XDA Developers forums. You'll find that someone usually has had the exact same problem as you, and in all probabilities you'll find an excellent solution here.



Things you can do post rooting

Once you've rooted your phone, it will open up a host of hidden features on your phone. For starters, you'll be able to flash custom ROMs such as ParanoidAndroid, LiquidSmooth, Android Open Kang Project, Cyanogenmod 10 and Xylon to name a few. You'll find many threads online which deal with installing/flashing these ROMs



Paranoid Android running on Nexus 4



CyanogenMod 10.1 which provides a customized Jelly Bean experience

Rootable Phones	Links
Samsung Galaxy Note	http://goo.gl/LJfzz
HTC One S	http://goo.gl/PLfyj
HTC One X	http://goo.gl/OLJlu
Sony Xperia S	http://goo.gl/WtunD
LG Optimus 4X HD	http://goo.gl/pNHfj
Samsung Galaxy Note 2	http://goo.gl/CGdxX
Google/LG Nexus 4	http://goo.gl/KtTxz
Samsung Galaxy SIII	http://goo.gl/XHt82
Samsung Galaxy SII	http://goo.gl/7k8gp
HTC Desire	http://goo.gl/4nWr4